

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Display My TV

Q Our educational institution wants to use 29-inch TVs as an output device instead of monitors. What computer configuration do we need for that purpose? We use a Pentium 4 2.4 GHz, an Intel GVSF original motherboard, 128 MB DDR RAM with a 40 GB hard disk, and need output to both TV and monitor.

AGS

A The hardware configuration that your institution currently uses is just perfect. However, you will need to install a display card with TV-out capability. Doing so will help you connect the computer to the TV. Since your motherboard does not have an AGP slot, you need to find a PCI display card with a TV-out connector. You can either use an S-Video cable, or a composite cable (if the video card supports it) to connect the TV.

Drained Batteries

Q I have a Pentium III 733 MHz, a 20 GB hard drive and 128 MB of RAM. For the past one year, my motherboard's battery has been draining swiftly. I have to correct the system clock every time I reboot. A couple of months back, the computer refused to boot as well. If I change the battery, everything starts working normally again, including the clock. Does a computer refuse to boot if the battery is completely dead? If yes, why does this happen, and is there something wrong with my motherboard?

Tejendra Nanabhai Pathare

A It is unusual for a battery to drain so quickly. Also, your computer should boot, regardless of whether the battery is dead or not. Your motherboard seems to have a problem, and you will need to contact your hardware vendor to solve this.

Missing Floppy Drive

Q I run Windows 2000 Professional. Recently, my floppy drive stopped showing up in My Computer. All the other drives display correctly. Under Floppy disk controllers, in the Computer Management console, it says that the drive is working properly. What is the problem?

Amit

A The BIOS doesn't seem to detect your floppy drive. Check the CMOS settings and see if the floppy drive is visible. Ensure that the CMOS is set to 'Halt on all errors' and also check that the BIOS 'Report the floppy drive to the OS' setting is enabled.

Another reason could be drive letter conflicts caused by software such as RAMdisk. TweakUI from PowerToys, which is available from the Microsoft Web site, can also cause drive letters to be hidden in Windows Explorer and My Computer. If you have it installed, go to Start > Settings > Control Panel and double-click on TweakUI. In the My Computer tab, select the checkboxes of the drives that are shown as hidden. Click Close, and restart your computer.

Sharing The Link

Q I am an IIT Bombay student. We access the Internet via a LAN from our rooms. The problem is, my room has only one LAN socket, but we have two computers in the same room, and want to connect both. How can we allow both to connect to the network using the single LAN socket? What hardware and software do we need? Also, this needs to be a solution for both Linux and Windows.

Vamsi Krishna

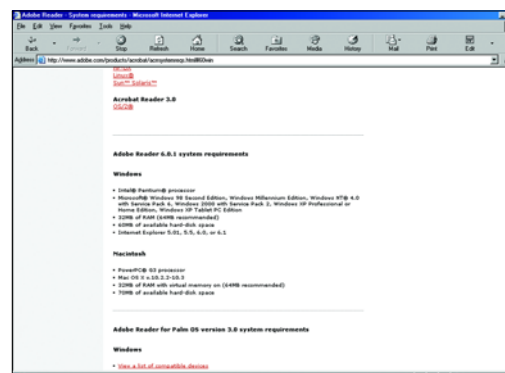
A The simplest solution is to buy a four-port hub, and connect that to your LAN socket. You can then connect up to four computers to that one LAN socket. A four-port hub costs around Rs 800.

Adobe Incompatibility

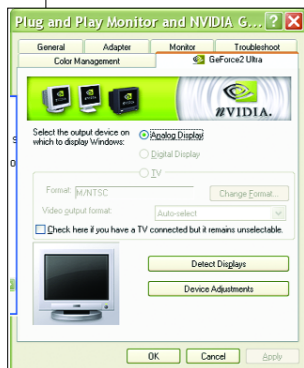
Q The Digit CD with archived content asks for Adobe Reader 6. I tried installing it from your CD, but I get an error saying the OS is not compatible. I run Windows 98 First Edition. Why is this so?

Dr Girish

A Adobe Reader 6, and above, are not compatible with Windows 98 First Edition. All you can do is either upgrade to Windows 98 SE or install Adobe Acrobat Reader 5. This



Adobe Reader 6 requires Windows 98SE and later OSes to work



The TV-Radio button is highlighted once you connect the TV to the graphics card



sos@jasubhai.com

E-mail us your computing problems, and we may answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!